

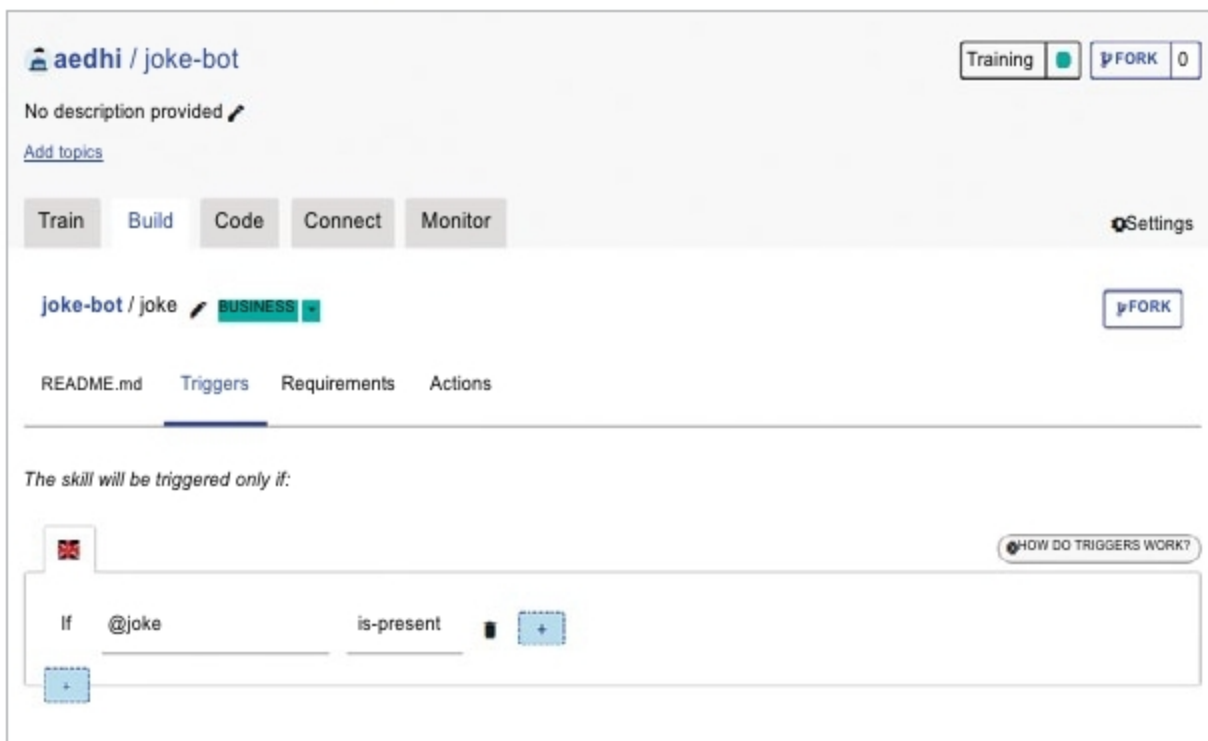


Fig. 9: Adding a trigger

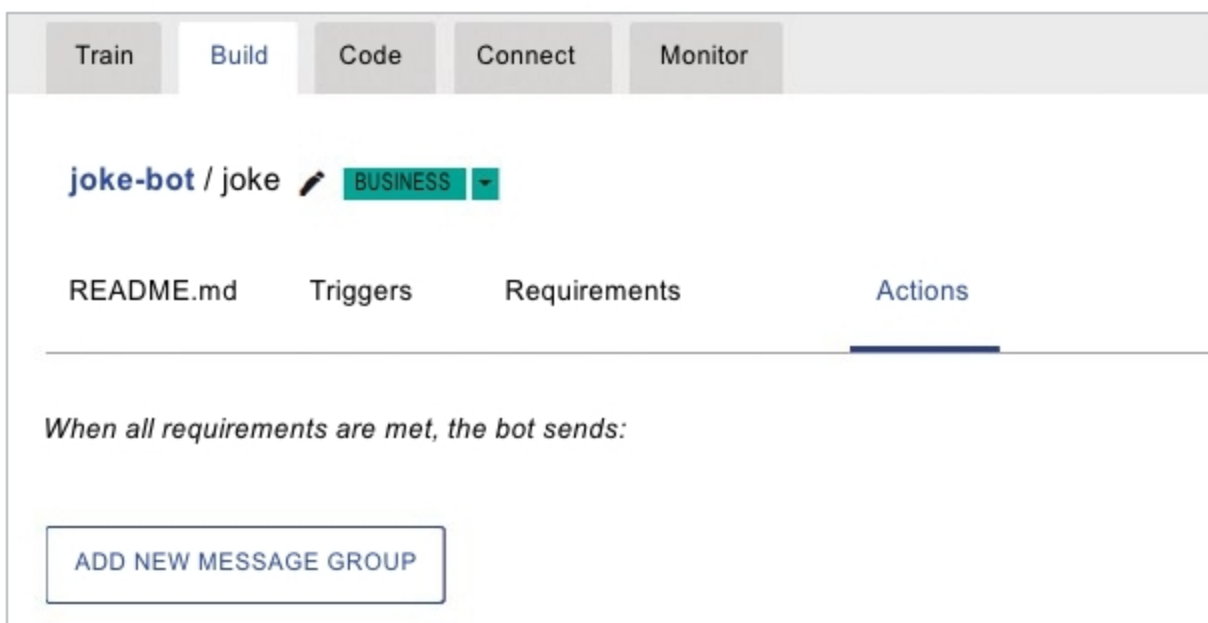


Fig. 10: Adding actions

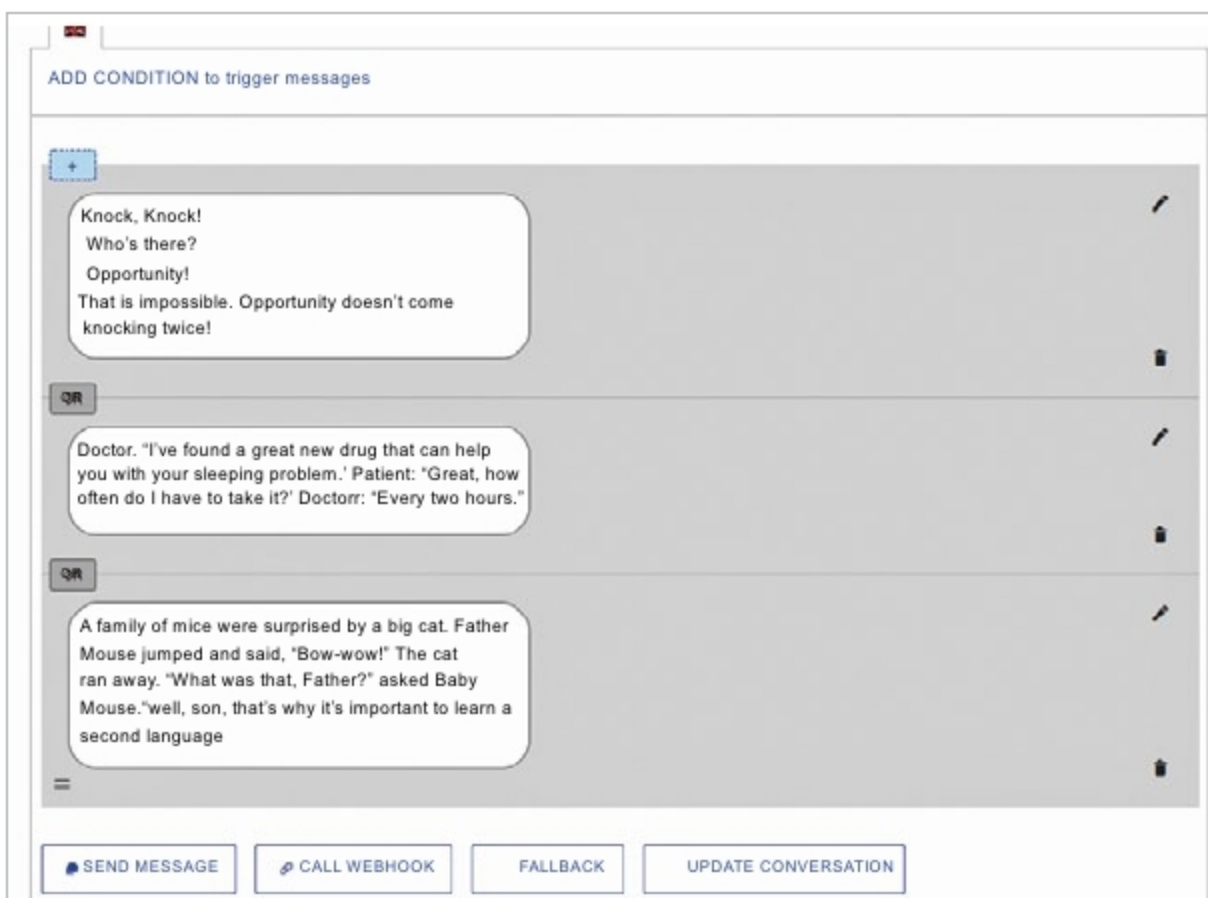


Fig. 11: Adding text messages

It need not be just a one query-answer set, but rather skills running through multiple exchanges. For example, consider a bot which helps you learn about currency exchange rates. It starts by asking the source currency, then the target currency, before giving the exact response. Skills can be combined to create complex conversational flows.

Here's how you create a skill for the joke bot:

- Go to the Build tab. Click on the + icon to create a skill.
- Name the skill Joke (Fig. 8)
- Once created, click on the skill. You will see four tabs. Read me, Triggers, Requirements and Actions.

• Navigate to the Requirements tab. You should store the information only if the intent joke is present. So, add a requirement as shown in Fig. 9.

Since this is a simple use case, you needn't consider any specific requirements in the Requirement tab. But consider a case for which a response needs to be triggered only if certain keywords or entities are present—in such a case you will need 'requirements'.

Requirements are either intents or entities that your skill needs to retrieve before executing actions. Requirements are pieces of information that are important in the conversation and that your bot can use; for example, the user's name or a location. Once a requirement is completed, the associated value is stored in the bot's memory for the entire conversation.

Now let us move to the Action tab to set the responses (see Fig. 10).

Click on Add new message group. Then select Send message and add a text message, which can be any joke in this case. Also, since you don't want your bot to crack the same joke each time, you can add multiple messages which will be randomly picked each time.

Channel integrations

Well, the success of a bot also depends upon how easily it is accessible. Recast has built-in integrations with many messaging channels such as Skype for Business, Kik Messenger, Telegram, Line, Facebook Messenger, Slack, Alexa, etc. In addition to that,